

JUNE 2, 2026

eff.org

CLAW BACK YOUR PRIVACY

JOIN EFF



We're Fighting Mass Surveillance Tech—and Winning

EFF is on the front lines of the fight against tech-enabled tyranny, but we aren't alone. Our team depends on your help to fight back against the surveillance state.

JOIN EFF

People around the world are pushing back against the mass surveillance that undermines privacy and free expression for everyone. [You can help during EFF's spring membership drive.](#)

One of the people who joined the fight for digital rights is EFF client Will Freeman. Will created the website DeFlock.me to reveal the dangers of automated license plate readers ([ALPRs](#))—cameras that collect location data on every vehicle they see and upload that to a massive nationwide police database. Deflock.me turns the tables by enlisting ordinary people to track the locations of tens of thousands of ALPR cameras.

But when the police spy-tech company [Flock Safety](#) went after Will's website with legal threats citing trademark law, he saw it for what it was: an attempt to silence critics and dim the light on mass surveillance.

The company will try everything it can to downplay the criticism, but EFF will be right there demanding accountability.

"I was totally unprepared to receive a cease & desist letter. I can see how most people would be bullied into submission by a threat like that. That's when I remembered Dave Maass from the EFF introduced himself via email several weeks before, so I reached out for help," Freeman says.

And that's when EFF stepped in. Recognizing DeFlock.me as a quintessential expression of grassroots advocacy and a form of criticism protected by the U.S. First Amendment, EFF's lawyers helped Will fight back. And the Big Surveillance Tech flinched.

But these battles against Flock's Spying tools rage on. In cities around the country, privacy advocates are pressuring officials to block or end contracts for ALPRs—and winning. The company will try everything it can to downplay the criticism, but EFF will be right there demanding accountability.



Get the new Claw Back member t-shirt featuring a fierce feline swatting at community surveillance. You might empathize with him, but there's a better way. Let's end the law enforcement contracts, harmful practices, and twisted logic that enable mass spying in the first place.

"I'm really grateful the EFF was able to step in and help. Without them, free speech would be only for those wealthy enough to defend themselves against billion dollar companies. We've grown a lot since then and are expanding our efforts to expose and push back against mass surveillance on our streets," Freeman says.

SUPPORT THE MOVEMENT

STOP MASS SURVEILLANCE TECH TODAY WHEN YOU JOIN EFF

EFF is a member-supported U.S. 501(c)(3) organization. We've received top ratings from the nonprofit watchdog Charity Navigator since 2013! Your donation is tax-deductible as allowed by law.



RELATED UPDATES



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS, RINDALA ALAJAJI | MAY 26, 2026

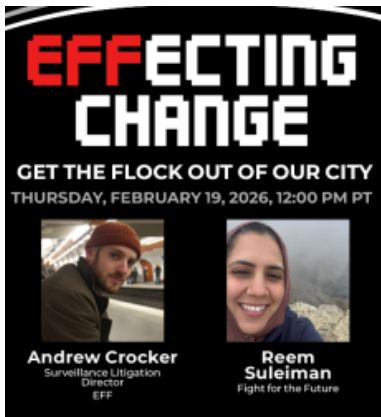
More License Plate Reader Mission Creep: School Residency Verification, Background Checks, and Noise Complaints



PRESS RELEASE | FEBRUARY 10, 2026

Coalition Urges California to Revoke Permits for Federal License Plate Reader Surveillance

EFFecting Change: Get the Flock Out of Our City



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY MELISSA SRAGO | FEBRUARY 9, 2026



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY COOPER QUINTIN | JANUARY 7, 2026

ICE Is Going on a Surveillance Shopping Spree



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS, RINDALA ALAJAJI | NOVEMBER 20, 2025

How Cops Are Using Flock Safety's ALPR Network to Surveil Protesters and Activists

Lawsuit Challenges San Jose's Warrantless ALPR Mass Surveillance



PRESS RELEASE | NOVEMBER 18, 2025



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY RINDALA ALAJAJI, DAVE MAASS |
NOVEMBER 3, 2025

License Plate Surveillance Logs Reveal Racist Policing Against Romani People

ELECTRONIC FRONTIER FOUNDATION
eff.org
Creative Commons Attribution License